earlier, the position had fallen vacant.[35] From mid-November 1906 to mid-1907 the company had no secretary, and VOC acted in that capacity for all practical purposes. For instance, a share application form of this time is addressed to 'the assistant secretary' of the company. S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, sometime in mid-1907 (certainly before August), became honorary secretary, a position he held almost until the end. For reasons unknown, SSNCo never had a full-time secretary apart from Fakir Mohammed's brief interlude.

At the time of registration fifteen directors were on the board. Three names from August—Haji Fakir Mohammed Sait, S.K.M. Mohideen Kadirsha Marakayar and Anthony Savarimuthu Rodriguez—were missing two months later for reasons unknown. Haji Fakir Mohammed Sait, as we saw, was apprehensive about the huge capital outlay. The exiting directors seem to have had reservations—commercial and/or political. The loss of Muslim directors was adequately compensated by the induction of other Muslims, but the absence of Anthony Savarimuthu Rodriguez meant that the company lost its only Paravar director.

The new additions were B. Venkataramanujulu Naidu, N.S. Deivanayagam Pillai, A.S.V. Tiruchittrambala Chettiar, A.A.A. Arumugam Chettiar and A.S. Solamalai Thevar (of Vaitheeswarankoil). All except the last were described as merchants of Tuticorin. (Parali Nellaiyappa Pillai mentions one Gopalaswamy Naidu, an affluent merchant of Tirunelveli and Tuticorin but his name does not figure anywhere.[36]) With a minimum of 100 qualifying shares we can estimate that, between them, the directors subscribed to at least 1,500 of the 20,000 shares.

Registering a joint-stock company—from far-off Tuticorin—could not have been easy. Hectic efforts went into the work leading up to the registration and after. VOC was the key player, racing against time, managing resources and putting the team together. His letter to C. Vijayaraghavachari, three days after the registration of the company, indicates this: